

MADONNA LILY

Lilium candidum

F: Liliaceae

Often encountered in Christian art as a symbol of purity, this widely cultivated lily is native to the E. Mediterranean.

2 m
6½ ft

female stigma
receives the
pollen

male stamen
releases the pollen

GIANT HIMALAYAN LILY

Cardiocrinum giganteum

F: Liliaceae

Found from the Himalayas to China, this giant lily grows for several seasons before flowering, after which the main plant dies.

3 m
10 ft

leaves arranged
spirally up stem

TRAILING LILY

Bomarea multiflora

F: Alstroemeriaceae

This many-stemmed climbing plant, with clusters of orange-red flowers, is native to S. America.

4 m
13 ft

GAGEA RETICULATA

F: Liliaceae

This small bulb-forming plant grows in open habitats across much of temperate Asia, as well as S.E. Europe and N. Africa.

15 cm
6 in

TURK'S CAP LILY

Lilium martagon

F: Liliaceae

This widespread Eurasian lily has the reflexed (backwards-bending) tepals that form the flower shape characteristic of the species.

2 m
6½ ft

FLAME LILY

Gloriosa superba

F: Colchicaceae

This striking plant, found from S. Africa to S.E. Asia, is a climber, clambering upwards with the aid of tendrils.

2 m/6½ ft

FLOWERHEADS

MEADOW SAFFRON

Colchicum autumnale

F: Colchicaceae

The crocus-like flowers of this European native appear in the autumn, months before its leaves. Despite being poisonous, it is cultivated widely.

15 cm
6 in

TYPICAL
LEAF

flower with
six tepals
(lobes)

leaf twists from
stem so underside
faces upwards

up to 40
tubular flowers

PERUVIAN LILY

Alstroemeria sp.

F: Alstroemeriaceae

This lily-like S. American genus includes many popular ornamentals. The leaves twist during growth to become anatomically upside down.

1.2 m
4 ft